COMMERCE INTELLIGENCE / OLIST

The promise gap

Management brief | Purchase cohorts: January 2017-August 2018 | 15 October 2026

Eligible delivered orders	On-time delivery	Median delivery time
96,203	93.2%	10.2 days

01 The March 2018 cohort needs investigation

March 2018 had **81.0%** on-time delivery versus **94.2%** in the other core-period months: a **13.1 percentage-point gap**. It contains 1,328 late orders from 7,003 eligible deliveries. The gap remains after destination-state standardization; eligibility is about 97.1% in both groups. This is a meaningful purchase-cohort signal, not a diagnosed cause or causal effect.

02 Separate a rate problem from a volume problem

Rio de Janeiro (RJ) had 1,495 late orders and a **12.1%** late rate (12,310 eligible). **Sao Paulo (SP)** had more late orders (1,817) but a lower 4.5% rate (40,399 eligible). Together they account for 50.7% of late orders; that concentration partly reflects volume.

03 Review timing changes the interpretation

Among selected reviews answered **after delivery**, low ratings (1-2 stars) were **19.5% for late orders** (n=1,907) versus **9.2% for on-time orders** (n=89,005). Post-delivery response coverage is only **29.2% of late orders** versus **99.3% of on-time orders**. This unequal selection prevents interpreting the rating gap as the effect of lateness.

Decision: investigate destination/cohort bottlenecks first, then test a narrow operational intervention. Do not infer savings or carrier fault from this dataset.

Evidence: reports/analysis/independent_cohort_audit.json and sql/analysis/. March-minus-other-month rate gap: -13.1 pp; descriptive 95% Wilson-Newcombe interval -14.1 to -12.2 pp. Month selected after inspection; clustering, selection and causal uncertainty remain.

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A focused improvement agenda

Proposed pilot actions, ownership and measures - not interventions already tested

01

Operations: investigate RJ lanes and peak cohorts

Review event quality and promise-setting for RJ, stratified by purchase month and category. Compare the weak March cohort with nearby cohorts before choosing a pilot. **Measure:** calendar-date on-time rate and P90 elapsed days. **Guardrails:** cancellations, volume and promised lead time; do not improve the rate simply by extending promises.

02

Seller operations: audit a bounded handoff queue

Start with the ranked single-seller queue and inspect the underlying orders before assigning responsibility. Anonymous Seller 7C67E144 has 963 eligible orders, 89 late outcomes and an 11.0-day median valid handoff stage; product and destination mix could explain part of the pattern. **Measure:** valid handoff time plus end-to-end on-time rate, using a comparable control group.

03

Customer experience: retain both survey clocks

Report pre-delivery and post-delivery feedback separately. Test proactive communication on a defined at-risk cohort, with a comparison group and a pre-agreed measurement window. **Measure:** post-delivery low-rating share and its response coverage. Survey timing and response selection remain part of interpretation.

Methods and limits

The source has 99,441 orders; the core period has 99,092. Delivery KPIs use 96,203 delivered orders with valid required dates. Delivery on the promised calendar date is on time. Reviews use one latest response per order, chosen deterministically. The single-seller diagnostic covers 98.7% of eligible deliveries. Stage metrics exclude their own chronology exceptions; their medians are not additive. Merchandise values exclude freight and are not adjusted for refunds; margin is unavailable. Exposure is not lost revenue. Carrier identity, actual logistics costs and causal intervention evidence are absent. SQL, independent Python checks, real Desktop DAX reconciliation, exception ledgers and source hashes accompany the project.

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